



Figure 2: DevOps job trends (Source: *Indeed.com*)

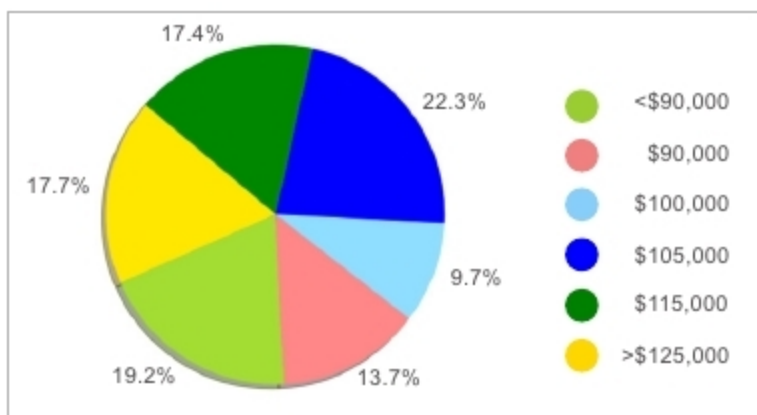


Figure 3: DevOps engineer salary ranges (Source: <https://blog.scalyr.com/2017/08/devops-job-market/>)

handle the support tasks, yet these are the key players for the support administrator.

Educational background for DevOps Jobs

If you are aspiring to make a career in DevOps, you must be strong in the concepts of the software development life cycle, including software development basics and automation testing fundamentals. In order to proceed further, you must attain certification courses.

Some popular certificate courses available in the market are listed below.

DevOps foundation course: Given below are the learning objectives of the course:

- DevOps objectives and vocabulary
- Benefits to business and IT
- DevOps link to Agile and Scrum
- Improved workflows and communication
- Automation practices including deployment pipelines

DevOps leader: Listed below are the learning objectives of the course:

- Key differences between DevOps IT and traditional IT
- Understanding performance and culture
- Designing a DevOps organisation
- Defining meaningful metrics
- Popular tools and key practices

DevOps security engineer: Shown below are the learning objectives of the course:

- Key differences between DevOps security and other security
- Business-driver security strategies
- Integrating security into continuous delivery workflow

Continuous delivery architect: Listed below are the learning objectives of the course:

- Design of modular and microservices
- Continuous integration

- Learning practices of continuous testing
- Monitoring and analysis infrastructure

Agile certified product owner:

Shown below are the learning objectives of this course:

- Product owner's roles and responsibilities
- Creating and utilising user stories
- Managing and prioritising process backlog
- Collaborating with stakeholders and other process owners
- Monitoring and measuring processes

What makes anyone an ideal DevOps engineer?

Apart from day-to-day regular DevOps skills, one must possess the following skills to stand ahead of the crowd.

Flexibility: Coding is an ever-changing and continuous process, where learning new things is always important. Ideal DevOps engineers should be flexible enough to change and adapt to the new evolving practices.

Security skills: DevOps works on a shorter cycle of development and deployment of code, which makes it vulnerable to security threats. As a DevOps engineer, you should not compromise on the security of the application.

Collaboration: A one man army is a strict no-no in DevOps. As a DevOps engineer, one should work collaboratively within a team, making the process cross-functional.

Scripting skills: It's obvious that you must know how to code in different programming languages, such as JavaScript, PHP, Python, etc, but also knowing how to write code to automatically assign IP addresses or DNS codes (which is replacing manual efforts) will definitely win the battle.

Decision making: Faster delivery implies that you must take critical decisions within a shorter time span without making too many iterations or changes.

Continued on page 39...

- the app in production. This person could be on the customer side, or on an outsourced DevOps team, depending on the project requirements and other factors.
- Team lead:** This is a position held by the most experienced team member, who can analyse the required skillset for each project and delegate the DevOps responsibilities across the team.
- Cloud architect:** This person should have ample hands-on experience with building cloud infrastructures and understanding what is to be included to support various types of apps and services, in production.
- Site reliability engineer (SRE):** This is the DevOps specialist who concentrates on ensuring a stable performance and uninterrupted availability of high-load apps across large-scale systems.
- DevOps systems administrator:** This is one of the main DevOps roles, as cloud monitoring accounts for more than half of all DevOps tasks and time. Each team member has to be able to